

3400 · NORTH END

3200 · CORE SPINE

3000 · PEABODY

2700 · ENP CORE

2500 · SOUTH END

HERITAGE · HIGHEST AND BEST USE · TENANT OWNERSHIP

PRICING THE UNPRICED

*Two projects on one deeply documented corridor:
what each building should become, given what it
was, and how a tenant who succeeds there can end
up owning it.*

1,874	3,602	1658	11
CORRIDOR PROPERTIES IN THE DATA PACKAGE	HAND-RESEARCHED HISTORICAL RECORDS	EARLIEST DATED RECORD · STANSBURY LAND ASSIGNMENT	WORKER AND TENANT OWNERSHIP CASES STUDIED

SPONSOR OF RECORD **BALTIMORE NEIGHBORHOOD BUSINESS DISTRICTS (JEFF JETTON, VP)** · STRATEGY
OXCART ASSEMBLY
FACULTY **MANNY PATOLE, NYU CUSP** · PRIMARY CUSP FOCUS AREA **URBAN INFRASTRUCTURE**
TWO SEMESTERS · SEPT 2026 – MAY 2027 · DATA PACKAGE [GITHUB.COM/JETTON999/PRICING-THE-UNPRICED](https://github.com/JETTON999/PRICING-THE-UNPRICED)

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01 ONE RECORD, TWO PROJECTS

The sponsor has spent years documenting the Greenmount corridor: deeds, directories, fire-insurance maps, newspapers, interment rolls, and per-property research papers, tied to 1,874 parcels. This proposal puts that record to two applied uses.

Idea 1 asks what an assemblage of corridor buildings should become. It starts from what each address was, on the premise that a documented historic use is a strong prior for a future one. It treats the history itself as a use too: a film, a podcast, an immersive walk-through, a revived trade name. It ends with an optimizer that assigns uses across a block without saturating it.

Idea 2 asks how the businesses the sponsor is recruiting into the corridor can end up owning their buildings. They sign as ordinary tenants of a small real estate trust. The project designs the lease that lets a tenant who succeeds buy the building on terms fixed at signing, while the trust's investors are still paid. It is grounded in eleven real worker and tenant buyouts in Baltimore, Washington, and New York.

THE RECORD

WHAT EXISTS

1,874 properties, 20,308 incident rows of which 3,602 are hand-researched, 3,103 people and businesses, 115 registered trademarks and patents, and a standalone map to browse it all.

IDEA 1

WHAT IT WAS, WHAT IT COULD BE

Use-history timelines, a candidate-use generator anchored to that history, a comps engine, and an assemblage optimizer with a saturation constraint.

IDEA 2

FROM TENANT TO OWNER

A case file, the lease mechanics, a two-sided cash-flow model stress-tested on a real restaurant's books, and a term sheet the sponsor can recruit with.

WHAT CHANGED SINCE THE JULY PROPOSAL

The July submission framed the capstone around scoring each property's documented history and testing that score against sale prices. **This revision replaces that with two applied projects that use the same record.** The data package, its layer distinction, and its warnings carry over unchanged. A team may take one idea or both; each stands on its own.

02 DEEP WHERE IT IS DEEP, SILENT WHERE IT IS SILENT

The incident table has 20,308 rows. That number is misleading on its own, and separating its two layers is the first job for either idea.

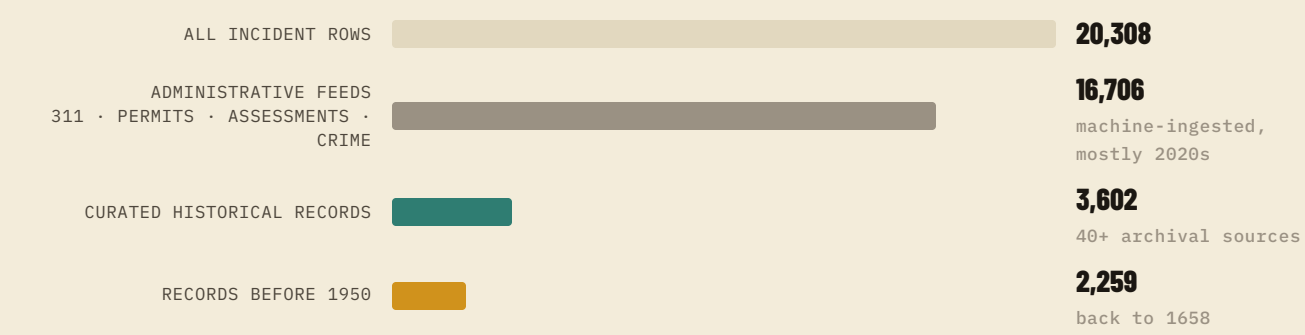


FIG. 1 • TWO LAYERS IN ONE TABLE. THE ADMINISTRATIVE LAYER IS VOLUME. THE CURATED LAYER IS THE HISTORY. A MODEL THAT REWARDS PAPERWORK LEARNS NOTHING ABOUT SIGNIFICANCE.

WHERE THE CURATED LAYER COMES FROM

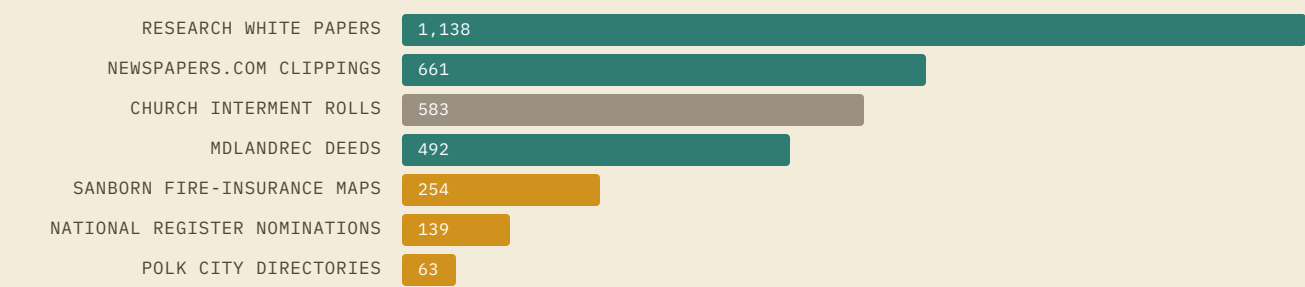


FIG. 2 • THE LARGEST CURATED SOURCES. AMBER MARKS THE SOURCES THAT STATE A BUILDING'S USE OUTRIGHT, WHICH IS WHAT IDEA 1 READS FIRST.

316	68	22	678
PROPERTIES WITH ANY CURATED RECORD	WITH TEN OR MORE	WITH TWENTY-FIVE OR MORE	BUSINESS-OPERATED-HERE LINKS

Sparse documentation is not evidence of no history. Research followed interest and grant funding, not a sampling frame. Treat the silent parcels as unmeasured.

03 WHAT IT WAS, WHAT IT COULD BE

Given an assemblage of properties, what should each one become, what would that earn, and does the mix work as a block?

The premise. Conventional highest-and-best-use analysis starts from zoning and square footage. This one starts from what the address was. A documented historic use is a strong prior for a future use: the building was built for it, and the neighborhood remembers it. The corridor's own record is the source of these priors.

One example. The corridor has two documented theatres: the Boulevard, an Art Deco house that ran from the 1920s to the 1970s, and the Waverly, built around 1910 and now a Shoe City. A live-music hall in the Boulevard is a use the building has already proven. That is one historic use inspiring one proposed use. The same move applies to every address with a use history: a former grocery, a hall, a bank, a garage, a church.

use history · 3313 Greenmount Ave · 85 use-bearing records · from the data package		
1905 · Zepp Photo Supply and Lanvale Cycle Co, at old 1129 York Road		Polk directory
1922 · R. M. Almond, furniture repaired and reupholstered		newspaper
1923 · Esselman Motor Co; permit for a two-story garage		newspaper · permit
1928 · Schwaab's Confectionery; Owings Bros.		newspaper
1930 · Boulevard Bowling Academy		newspaper
1947 · Wagner's Food Stores		newspaper
1962-70 · Eddie's, Save-A-Dollar, Shapiro's, Foodland		newspaper
1985 · Kawasaki dealership		newspaper
2013 · contributing resource, Waverly Main Street Historic District		NRHP

FIG. 3 · A FIRST USE HISTORY, STRAIGHT FROM THE EXPORT. PHOTO SUPPLY, BICYCLES, AUTOS, CANDY, BOWLING, FORTY YEARS OF GROCERIES, MOTORCYCLES. THE STARTER NOTEBOOK PRINTS THIS IN ONE CELL; THE MAP APP SHOWS IT ON A CLICK.

USES BEYOND THE BUILDING

A "use" need not be a tenant. The history is also raw material, and the sponsor already treats it that way, anchoring new works to a deed: a feature film rooted in the 1858 arson at St. John's, 3009 Greenmount, and an album rooted in a razed home on Barclay Street. The optimizer should be able to consider:

- **Screen and audio.** A documentary, series, or podcast per block or per property. The 1,138 research white papers are the treatments; 115 registered trademarks and patents tied to corridor addresses are story seeds.
- **Immersive experience, in the Meow Wolf mode.** One large vacant footprint becomes a walk-through of the corridor's own strata: the 1688 land patents, the turnpike tollgate, Mechanics' Hall, the theatres, the enslavers in the chain of title. The deepest-documented properties tell you which rooms have the most material.
- **Heritage revivals.** Reopen a business under its documented historic name and trade dress. The trademark research to clear the name is already in hand.
- **Interpretive layer.** Walking tours, plaques, an AR overlay on the storefronts. Cheap, and it lifts every other use on the block.

Content uses do not saturate: a podcast about the Boulevard does not compete with a concert hall in it. Venues do saturate. The model treats the two differently.

03 FROM TIMELINE TO ASSEMBLAGE

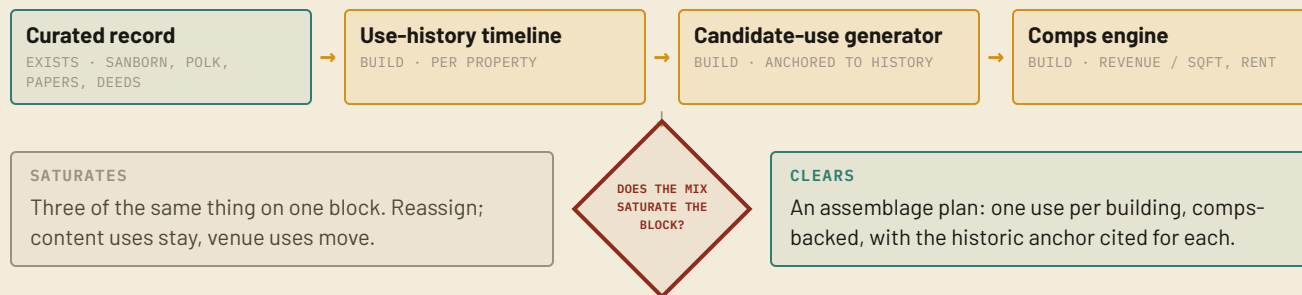


FIG. 4 · IDEA 1 AS A PIPELINE. TEAL EXISTS; AMBER IS BUILT. THE GATE IS THE SATURATION CONSTRAINT, MEASURED AGAINST THE CORRIDOR'S EXISTING BUSINESS MIX.

WHAT STUDENTS BUILD

- **COMMITTED** A **use-history timeline** per property, extracted from the curated layer.
- **COMMITTED** A **candidate-use generator** that proposes uses anchored to that history, including content and experience uses.
- **COMMITTED** A **comps engine**: operating examples of each candidate use in comparable corridors, with revenue per square foot and achievable rent.
- **COMMITTED** An **assemblage optimizer** that assigns uses across a block side with a saturation constraint.

WHAT THE DATA ALREADY HOLDS

- **Use history per address.** Sanborn footprints and uses (1915), Polk directories, 661 clippings, 678 business-operated-here links, National Register nomination text.
- **Present state per property.** Zoning, year built, square footage, dwelling units, permits, vacancy, violations, tax certificates, receivership, whether a business trades there.
- **Market context per property.** Market typology, median sale price, days on market, inventory; HUD fair market rent; median household income; walkability and transit access; historic district, main street, opportunity zone, and CDBG flags. Nearby business counts and walk scores are empty in this export.
- **Assemblages.** The export has no acquisition groupings. Block side (141 values) is the default unit; the sponsor names specific assemblages.
- **One calibration point.** Daily sales for an operating restaurant at 2731 Greenmount, from the sponsor under NDA, to sanity-check revenue estimates.

Hard parts. A property with lots of paperwork is not necessarily significant. Comps will mostly come from outside Baltimore. "Over-saturated" needs a definition students can defend.

04 FROM TENANT TO OWNER

Design a lease that starts a business as an ordinary tenant and ends with it owning the building, while the trust's investors still get paid.

Why. The sponsor is recruiting businesses to start and operate in the corridor. They sign as regular tenants of a small real estate investment trust. The idea is that a tenant who succeeds can buy its building from the trust, on terms fixed at signing. That gives the trust an exit other than a sale to an institutional buyer, and keeps the upside in the neighborhood. Worker buyouts are now routine in Baltimore. A tenant path to owning the *building* is not.

WHAT THE LOCAL RECORD SHOWS

Eleven cases were checked. The ones that matter:

CASE	YEAR	WHAT MOVED	STRUCTURE	FINANCING	BUILDING?
Wine Source, Hampden	2024	Business	Worker co-op	BRED loan, GoFundMe	No , founder kept it
Waverly Ace Hardware (13-store chain)	2021	Business, 30% then phased to 100%	ESOP	National Cooperative Bank	Not reported
Common Ground Café, Hampden	2023	Business + lease	Worker co-op	BRED, GoFundMe	No
Tabard Inn, DC	1993 / 2018	Shares, 30% then 51%	ESOP	Undisclosed	Unconfirmed
Red Emma's, 3128 Greenmount	2021–22	Two buildings	Worker co-op	Seed Commons line, MD capital grant, CBP fund, ~\$1.6M	Yes
WaterBottle co-op, West Baltimore	2020	Contracting firm + rentals	Worker co-op	BRED, ~\$5M cumulative, 22 homes	Yes
East New York Community Land Trust, Brooklyn	2026	9,500 sf commercial	CLT	\$1M state, \$650k CDFI loan, \$720k crowdfund; \$2.3M price	Yes
3218 Wisconsin Ave, DC	2019	20-unit apartment	Limited-equity co-op via TOPA	LISC, DC Preservation Fund	Yes
Plaza 122, Portland	2014–17	29k sf strip retail	Community Investment Trust	Bank at 75% LTV, sub-debt at 2–4%, \$10/mo shares	Yes

Sources and the two unverified rows are documented in `docs/worker-owned-exits.md` in the data package. Deal prices in worker buyouts are almost never disclosed.

04 WHAT THE CASES TEACH

- **Worker buyouts almost always exclude the real estate.** The seller keeps the dirt and the co-op leases. The two Baltimore co-ops that own property bought it later, with separate and larger financing. A trust buyout looks like the land-trust and investment-trust cases, not the co-op conversions.
- **One lender does most Baltimore deals.** BRED, backed by Seed Commons: repayment as a share of net profit, no personal guarantees. It is a business lender; its real-estate exposure is the exception. NYC analogs are New Economy Project and The Working World; DC's are LISC and the DC Preservation Fund.
- **Seller financing showed up in none of the cases.** Bank plus CDFI, or CDFI alone, was the norm. Existing mortgages on the trust's buildings would need lender consent, not a seller note.
- **Every real-estate case used public capital.** State grants for Red Emma's, a state earmark for East New York, DHCD money in DC. Crowdfunding is real but small.
- **Plaza 122 is the only case where neighbors, not just tenants, bought in and could exit.** Ten dollars a month, a bank letter of credit against loss, 9% dividends. That securities scaffolding is the template for a tenants-plus-neighbors buyout.
- **ESOPs suit scale and phase in over years.** Co-ops suit storefronts and close in months.

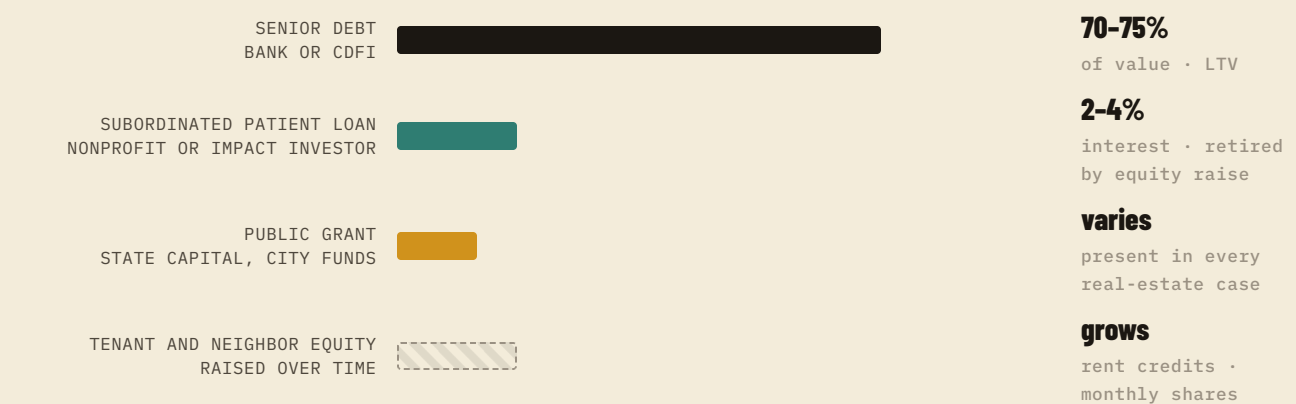


FIG. 5 • THE CAPITAL STACK THAT RECURS. THE HATCHED BAR IS WHAT THE LEASE DESIGNS: EQUITY THAT ACCRUES TO THE TENANT AND, IN THE PLAZA 122 MODEL, TO NEIGHBORS, UNTIL IT RETIRES THE SUBORDINATED LOAN.

WHAT STUDENTS BUILD

- **COMMITTED** A **case file**: the table above, extended and verified, with the public deal terms. Interviews with BRED, Red Emma's, and the Ace owners on what they would do differently.
- **COMMITTED** The **lease mechanics**: how rent accrues toward equity, what triggers the option to buy, whether the price is set at signing or at conversion, and what happens if the tenant leaves early.
- **COMMITTED** A **two-sided cash-flow model**: tenant cost of occupancy over the lease; investor return under a range of conversion timings; the Plaza 122 stack tested against corridor numbers.
- **COMMITTED** A **stress test on real books**: can a new restaurant's margin carry rent now, and a mortgage at 75% loan-to-value plus sub-debt later?
- **COMMITTED** A **lease-with-option term sheet** the sponsor can use in recruiting.

WHAT THE DATA ALREADY HOLDS

- **Property level, in the export.** Last sale price and date, assessed value, an automated value estimate, fair market rent, owner name and type, ground rent, and baseline snapshots frozen on two dates in July 2026.
- **Tenant level, from the sponsor under NDA.** Daily sales, channel split, and profit and loss for the operating restaurant at 2731 Greenmount.
- **Deal level, from the sponsor.** Which properties the trust holds, lease terms, investor return targets, and the cap table.

Hard parts. New businesses fail often, and the lease has to survive that. Restaurant margins are thin. Fixing a price years ahead means someone bears the appreciation risk. Buildings with several tenants need a rule for who buys. Securities law applies once neighbors are buying shares.

05 EVERYTHING STUDENTS NEED IS IN THE REPO

The data package is a public GitHub repository. No sponsor systems, logins, or installs are required to begin. Students never need to touch the sponsor's production tools.

FILE	ROWS	WHAT IT IS
properties.csv	1,874	Properties with ~80 fields: assessment, sale history, vacancy, zoning, market, transit, program flags. 1,791 have coordinates.
property_incidents.csv	20,308	The claim layer: every dated event at an address, with source, evidence status, date precision, sensitivity, rights.
subjects.csv	3,103	People, businesses, organizations, families, congregations.
incident_subjects.csv	5,462	Who did what at which address: owned, operated_at, sold, lived_at, interred_at.
incident_links.csv	236	Claim-to-claim links, including 3 contradictions.
registered_ips.csv	115	Trademarks and patents with an address of record.
property_parcel.csv	50,860	The SDAT parcel roll: the linkage layer.
grant_program_matches.csv	11,789	Property-to-program eligibility matches.
baseline_snapshots.csv	887	Two July 2026 capture days, 29 fields each: the "before" line.

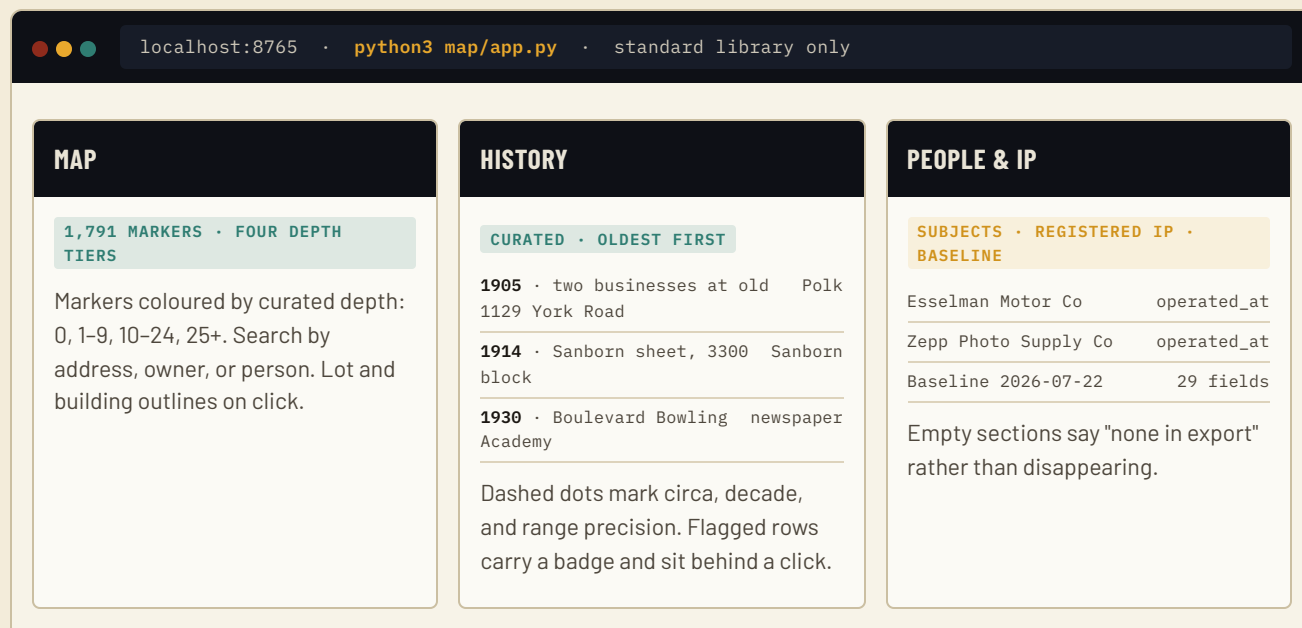


FIG. 6 · THE STANDALONE MAP APP SHIPPED WITH THE DATA. ONE PYTHON FILE, ONE HTML PAGE, NO INSTALL. ITS CHECK MODE REPRODUCES THE 3,602 / 16,706 LAYER SPLIT.

- **START_HERE.ipynb.** Loads the nine tables, separates the layers, ranks properties by depth, then splits by idea: use histories and block-side assemblage units for Idea 1; commercial sale prices, the July baseline, and a first lease-to-own calculator for Idea 2.
- **verify_claims.py.** Checks every number in the README against the CSVs. Standard library only.
- **docs/worker-owned-exits.md.** The eleven-case research file behind Idea 2, with sources.
- **public_sources/.** The 1937 HOLC redlining polygons for Baltimore.

- **From the sponsor, under NDA.** Restaurant sales and P&L for 2731 Greenmount; trust holdings, lease terms, investor targets; named assemblages.

06 READ THE RECORD, THEN BUILD ON IT

SEPT DATA READINESS	OCT USE HISTORIES · CASE FILE	NOV CANDIDATE USES · LEASE MECHANICS	DEC FALL DEMO	FEB COMPS · CASH- FLOW MODEL	MAR OPTIMIZER · STRESS TEST	APR-MAY HARDEN · HAND OFF
◆ LAYER SPLIT REPRODUCED; SILENCES MAPPED	◆ FIRST USE HISTORIES FOR THE DEEP 68	◆ INTERVIEWS WITH BRED, RED EMMA'S, ACE	◆ ASSEMBLAGE PLAN V0 · TERM SHEET V0	◆ RESTAURANT BOOKS UNDER NDA	◆ SPONSOR SIGN-OFF · PUBLIC REPO UPDATED	

FIG. 7 · NINE MONTHS, TWO TRACKS. FALL READS THE RECORD AND BUILDS FIRST VERSIONS. SPRING TESTS THEM AGAINST COMPS AND REAL BOOKS, THEN HANDS OFF.

FALL: BUILD AND DEMONSTRATE

- **Idea 1.** Extract use histories for the 68 properties with ten or more curated records. Draft the candidate-use generator. Define saturation against the corridor's existing business mix.
- **Idea 2.** Verify and extend the case file. Interview the Baltimore lenders and co-ops. Draft the lease mechanics and a first term sheet.
- **Both.** A data-readiness memo: what the export can and cannot answer, and which silences matter.

SPRING: VALIDATE, HARDEN, HAND OFF

- **Idea 1.** Comps from comparable corridors. The optimizer on one sponsor-named assemblage. A written plan the sponsor can take to a lender.
- **Idea 2.** The two-sided cash-flow model. The stress test on the 2731 Greenmount books. A term sheet the sponsor can put in front of a lawyer.

SKILLS THE WORK EXERCISES

Record linkage and text extraction across archival sources; spatial analysis at block-side scale; market research and comparable analysis; real estate finance and cash-flow modeling; qualitative interviewing; and writing for a sponsor who will act on the result.

07 WHAT EACH IDEA PRODUCES

IDEA 1

- **COMMITTED** Use-history timelines, as a table and as an addition to the map app.
- **COMMITTED** The candidate-use generator with its rules written down.
- **COMMITTED** A comps library with sources.
- **COMMITTED** An assemblage plan for one sponsor-named assemblage, with the saturation analysis behind it.

IDEA 2

- **COMMITTED** The verified case file and interview notes.
- **COMMITTED** The lease mechanics memo.
- **COMMITTED** The two-sided cash-flow model, as a spreadsheet or notebook, with the stress-test results.
- **COMMITTED** A lease-with-option term sheet.

BOTH

- **COMMITTED** The data-readiness memo.
- **COMMITTED** Code and documentation back into the public repository, runnable with no install step.
- **CONDITIONAL** One creative prototype, if the core stays on track: a pilot podcast episode, an immersive-room treatment, or a revived trade-dress study.

A team may take one idea or both. Each is scoped to stand alone, and the shared deliverables are the same either way.

08 PUBLIC DUTIES, NAMED

- **No personal data.** Owner names are SDAT public record. Seventeen contact phone numbers were redacted before publication. Nothing in the package is private.
- **Sensitivity flags are a design input.** Fifty-two incident rows are flagged trauma, personal rights, displacement, or commercialization. They are sourced to published reporting and public records. They exist so that a use proposal or a public narrative does not surface a terrible event with no framing. They are never dropped and never quoted verbatim without review.
- **No appraisals.** Revenue estimates and comps are planning figures with stated assumptions, never a valuation, promise, or guaranteed return. Assessed value is an administrative number, not a market price.
- **Securities law.** Any structure in which neighbors buy shares needs counsel before it is offered. The term sheet is a starting point for a lawyer, not an offering.
- **Extraction.** The point of Idea 2 is to keep upside in the neighborhood. The point of Idea 1 is to propose uses the corridor recognises as its own. Both are judged against that.
- **If it fails.** If comps cannot be found for a candidate use, the plan says so. If no lease survives the stress test, the finding is that the model needs more public capital, and that is the deliverable.

WHAT THE SPONSOR PROVIDES

- The public data package, maintained on GitHub, with the standalone map and notebook.
- Under NDA: restaurant books for 2731 Greenmount, trust holdings and lease terms, investor targets, named assemblages.
- Introductions to BRED, Red Emma's, the Ace Hardware owners, and the Waverly Main Street organisation.
- Deployment and maintenance of anything the sponsor adopts. Students are not the IT department.

SOURCES

- Greenmount Corridor knowledge base, Oxcart Assembly / BNBD, 2026. CC BY 4.0. github.com/jetton999/pricing-the-unpriced
- Waverly Main Street Historic District, National Register nomination B-5229, Maryland Historical Trust, 2013.
- The Baltimore Banner, "Wine Source becomes a worker-owned cooperative," 2024. Baltimore Fishbowl, "From Red Emma's to the Wine Source," 2024.
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- Baltimore Brew, "Red Emma's move is seen as a boost for Greenmount Avenue and Waverly," May 2021. Seed Commons, "An ecosystem for economic democracy."
- Next City, "When a café owner shut down his business, workers revived it as a co-op," 2023.
- Brownstoner and New Economy Project on the East New York Community Land Trust purchase of 161 Jamaica Avenue, 2026.
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- Mercy Corps, East Portland Community Investment Trust case study; Next City, "How these Portland residents got to own a piece of their neighborhood."
- Mapping Inequality: Redlining in New Deal America, Digital Scholarship Lab, University of Richmond. HOLC Baltimore, 1937. CC BY-NC-SA 4.0.